

BRAND LANDSCAPE

PROPHET · WORLD CUP 2026 · 20-SITE EU-WEIGHTED SAMPLE

2026-05-02 · V1 · FOR ADI

1 · THE FIELD

Twenty sites across four buckets: **direct competitors / odds-comparison** (six), **quality football publications** (six), **football-native consumer products** (five), and **gambling-promo "AVOID"** cases (three). Palettes sampled from rendered pages. Register scored 1–4: tipster · promo · product · publication.

Action Network

ODDS / AGGREGATOR

US sports-betting media — dark teal/navy, bonus banners, picks-driven

REG 2/4

dark

Betfair (sub for Smarkets)

ODDS / AGGREGATOR

UK exchange — yellow/black masthead, dense odds grid, casino-adjacent

REG 2/4

light

OddsPortal

ODDS / AGGREGATOR

Spreadsheet-grade odds aggregator — utilitarian, brown/grey data interface

REG 3/4

light

Oddschecker

ODDS / AGGREGATOR

Aggregator portal — green CTAs, dense odds tables, free-bet promos crowd the masthead

REG 2/4

light

Pinnacle

ODDS / AGGREGATOR

Sportsbook UI in deep navy + electric blue — sharper, more product than promo

REG 3/4

light

Polymarket

ODDS / AGGREGATOR

Prediction-market scoreboard — minimalist white, blue/yellow/orange data lines, news cards

REG 3/4

light

Coaches' Voice

PUBLICATION

B2B coaching education — orange/black/white, tactical-thinking SaaS-meets-publication

REG 4/4

light

Mundial (sub for Tifo)

PUBLICATION

Football zine / streetwear — high-contrast B&W, photography-led, indie publication

REG 4/4

light

Scouted Football

PUBLICATION

Digital football magazine — single deep-red brand color on white, scouting-prospects voice

REG 4/4

light

The Athletic (Football)

PUBLICATION

Newspaper-grade football longform — black-and-white masthead, single red accent

REG 4/4

light

The Blizzard

PUBLICATION

Quarterly long-form football mag — cream + hot pink, serious-fan zine

REG 4/4

light

The Set Pieces

PUBLICATION

Old-school football blog turned mag — cream backgrounds, orange/red illustrations, retro feel

REG 4/4

light

BBC Sport (Football)

CONSUMER PRODUCT

Broadcast-grade news — yellow Sport sub-bar, BBC red accents, photo-led editorial cards

REG 3/4

light

FotMob

CONSUMER PRODUCT

Live-scores app — clean white, league iconography, single green accent for live state

REG 3/4

light

Goal

CONSUMER PRODUCT

International football news portal — black/grey + orange, ad-heavy, transfer-rumor energy

REG 3/4

light

Sky Sports (Football)

CONSUMER PRODUCT

TV-network sport site — deep navy + red, gradient headers, premier-league-saturated

REG 3/4

light

Sofascore

CONSUMER PRODUCT

Scoreboard utility — deep navy header + red live indicator, dense fixture list

REG 3/4

light

Paddy Power (AVOID)

AVOID · GAMBLING-PROMO

Loud Irish bookmaker — kelly green + black, transgressive humor, max promo

REG 1/4

light

William Hill (AVOID)

AVOID · GAMBLING-PROMO

UK heritage bookmaker — deep navy + yellow, '€200 free bet' promo register

REG 1/4

dark

bet365 (AVOID)

AVOID · GAMBLING-PROMO

World's #1 sportsbook — dark green + yellow, casino-grade data density, promo modals

REG 1/4

dark

●

ODDS / AGGREGATOR

●

PUBLICATION

●

CONSUMER PRODUCT

●

AVOID (GAMBLING-PROMO)

● ODDS / AGGREGATOR ● PUBLICATION ● CONSUMER PRODUCT ● AVOID (GAMBLING-PROMO)

CLUSTER MAP

WHERE THE WHITE SPACE IS

2 OF 4 · PLOT OF THE 20-SITE FIELD

2 · WHERE THE WHITE SPACE IS

Each site placed by a single best-fit reading on two axes. **X-axis:** publication ◀ product (does it read as editorial writing or as a tool?). **Y-axis:** muted ◀ bold (does the visual register whisper or shout?). Crowded zones are red flags; empty zones are opportunities. The dashed box marks the most distinctive uncrowded area for a football brand.



Crowded zones:

- **Top-right (bold + product)** — every gambling promo (bet365, William Hill, Paddy, Action Network) and every "loud" sports news portal (Goal, Sky, Sofascore-leaning, Oddschecker). The least useful place to land.
- **Bottom-right (muted + product)** — Pinnacle, OddsPortal, FotMob, Polymarket. Clinical SaaS-grade tooling. Owns "trustworthy data utility." Hard to compete; not the brand's wedge anyway.
- **Bottom-left (muted + publication)** — The Athletic, Mundial, Set Pieces, Coaches' Voice. The B&W editorial corner. Premium but requires decades of credibility to land here on day one.

Where the white space is:

- **Mid-left (publication, slightly bold)** — only The Blizzard sits here (cream + hot pink) and Scouted FC (red on white). Distinctive, *not* gambling, *not* commodity score-tracker.
- **Dark-mode editorial** — completely unowned. Every football publication defaults to white-paper. The dark-mode sites in the sample are all gambling (bet365, Action Network) — owning dark-mode-as-publication is genuinely empty quadrant.
- **Warm/muted but not B&W** — cream-paper + a non-default accent (anything that isn't red/yellow/Sky-navy) is uncontested.

VERDICT

THREE DIRECTIONS · ONE SHIP

3 OF 4 · SHIP BY MONDAY

3 · THREE PALETTE DIRECTIONS

Each of these earns its rationale from the field above. None of them are safe defaults — each one chooses a piece of unowned territory. The recommendation is below; if the chosen one does not feel inevitable on second viewing, the other two are real fallbacks rather than consolation prizes.

A · BROADSHEET

#F4EFE2 · #15171C · #7A1E26 · #9B927C · #FFFFFF

Warm chalk-cream, ink black, single oxblood accent. Reads as a Sunday-broadsheet football section. **Earns its place** by sitting next to The Athletic / Set Pieces but using oxblood (not BBC red, not Athletic red, not Scouted red) — a deeper, ink-printed shade. **Risk:** in five seconds, casual fans may not differentiate it from existing prestige editorial.

THE SCOUT

SCOUT REPORT

BRAZIL'S PATH TO THE FINAL, SCOUTED.

Three things the markets are missing about Tite's side, what to back, what to fade.

FIX 14 BRA v ARG EDGE +4.2%

B · FLOODLIGHT · **RECOMMENDED**

#0F1115 · #EDE6D2 · #F2A93B · #3B463F · #1A1D24

Ink-black background, warm parchment text, sodium-amber accent — like a stadium under floodlights. **Earns its place** because the entire sampled field defaults to white paper, and the only dark-mode sites are gambling promos. A dark-mode *publication* is genuinely uncrowded in football. The reticle motif renders dramatically against ink. Sodium-amber is football-native (literal floodlight reference) and unused by any peer in the sample.

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C · PITCH

#F5F4EE · #2E3A2A · #C24F2A · #B7B6A8 · #15171C

Stone-cream paper + deep-pitch moss + a single signal-orange accent. Extension of the original Scout direction. **Earns its place** because no sampled site combines these three — the moss is darker than any sportsbook green and warmer than any utility navy. Signal-orange echoes a referee flag without leaning gambling-promo. **Risk:** proximity to existing Scouted-the-publication and Coaches' Voice (orange-on-white) means the visual hook lands on the accent color rather than the system.

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Recommendation: ship Direction B — "Floodlight." The sampled field shows that every football publication defaults to white-paper editorial, and every dark-mode site in the category is a gambling promo. A dark-mode editorial brand is the only quadrant where the visual register *itself* communicates "publication, not bookmaker" before a reader has parsed a single word. Sodium-amber is football-native (floodlight, captain's armband, late-evening kickoff) and lands as a distinctive accent that no peer owns. The reticle/scope motif gains contrast and gravity against ink. **Strongest single reason:** in a field where category-shift requires earning trust on day one, picking the unowned quadrant of the cluster map is the cheapest way to be remembered. **Strongest second reason:** dark mode dramatizes the scout-report stamp far better than cream-paper does — every "scout report" headline reads as a briefing in a coach's office, not a Sunday-broadsheet column.

RECEIPTS

ALL 20 SITES · STRESS-TEST THE CALL

4 OF 4 · SOURCED 2026-05-02

4 · RECEIPTS

Every input behind the verdict. Register scored 1–4 (tipster · promo · product · publication). Hex codes sampled from rendered homepage pixels (1280×800) at the dates noted, with manual visual confirmation against algorithmic median-cut output. Audience signal is the most defensible public number per site (X followers OR Similarweb monthly visits OR app downloads).

SITE	BUCKET	PALETTE (SAMPLED)	REG	TYPE	MODE	AUDIENCE	VIBE
Oddschecker oddschecker.com	Odds	 #0B0D10 #FFFFFF #1ABE6E #A9B7BE #D0D6DA	2/4	Sans (Inter-ish), proportional, mid weight; data-table heavy	light	~30M visits/mo (Similarweb); UK leader, 75% male	Aggregator portal — green CTAs, dense odds tables, free-bet promos crowd the masthead
Pinnacle pinnacle.com	Odds	 #05294E #046DF6 #0A182A #FFFFFF #F1F3F7	3/4	Sans condensed, lighter weights for body, bold blue for emphasis	light	Top-200 sportsbook globally per Similarweb; sharp/pro audience	Sportsbook UI in deep navy + electric blue — sharper, more product than promo
OddsPortal oddsportal.com	Odds	 #2E3739 #894721 #FFFFFF #5C594C #232323	3/4	Sans, dense tabular, lots of small text	light	#11 Sports Betting category, ~83% male, 35-44 skew	Spreadsheet-grade odds aggregator — utilitarian, brown/grey data interface
Betfair (sub for Smarkets) betfair.com/exchange	Odds	 #FFB80C #1F1F1F #FFFFFF #444444 #28392B	2/4	Sans bold, data tables, yellow/black gambling-exchange	light	UK is top market; bet365 is closest peer at ~108M/mo	UK exchange — yellow/black masthead, dense odds grid, casino-adjacent
Polymarket polymarket.com	Odds	 #FFFFFF #2145B2 #1B1F2A #F4D74E #DC6E2A	3/4	Sans (Inter), proportional, light/regular weights — clean SaaS	light	~688K MAU (record Feb 2026, Token Terminal)	Prediction-market scoreboard — minimalist white, blue/yellow/orange data lines, news cards
Action Network actionnetwork.com	Odds	 #03241D #03A57B #122945 #FFFFFF #0E2231	2/4	Sans, mixed weights, sportsbook-promo styling	dark	247K X followers; major US betting media	US sports-betting media — dark teal/navy, bonus banners, picks-driven
The Athletic (Football) nytimes.com/athletic/football	Pub.	 #FFFFFF #1A1A1A #A41C20 #9E9E9E #2B2B2B	4/4	Editorial serif headlines (NYT Cheltenham/Chronicle-ish) + sans body	light	@TheAthleticFC ~1M followers; @TheAthletic 867K	Newspaper-grade football longform — black-and-white masthead, single red accent
Mundial (sub for Tifo) mundialmag.com	Pub.	 #1F1F1F #FFFFFF #D9D2C5 #7C6A50 #2A2A2A	4/4	Heavy condensed serif wordmark + neo-grotesque body	light	Niche football culture mag; print + Shopify shop	Football zine / streetwear — high-contrast B&W, photography-led, indie publication
Scouted Football scoutedftbl.com	Pub.	 #9A2230 #FFFFFF #1E1617 #592D2B #F0F0F0	4/4	Bold sans wordmark, modern editorial, single brand red	light	Niche; Substack-tier scouting publication	Digital football magazine — single deep-red brand color on white, scouting-prospects voice
The Blizzard theblizzard.co.uk	Pub.	 #F6F5EF #1A1A1A #E81355 #FFFFFF #46061A	4/4	Serif masthead (Garamond-ish) + bold display sans for hero	light	Subscription-only print quarterly, J. Wilson edited	Quarterly long-form football mag — cream + hot pink, serious-fan zine
Coaches' Voice coachesvoice.com	Pub.	 #FFFFFF #FF6600 #1F1F1F #333F47 #2D2D2D	4/4	Modern sans (Inter), minimal serif accents, clean editorial	light	Coaching-industry vertical; lower-volume but high-credibility	B2B coaching education — orange/black/white, tactical-thinking SaaS-meets-publication
The Set Pieces thesetpieces.com	Pub.	 #FFF6F2 #0B0B0B #C75109 #11174E #DA301D	4/4	Slab serif logo + traditional editorial card grid	light	Mid-tier football blog; established UK voice	Old-school football blog turned mag — cream backgrounds, orange/red illustrations, retro feel
FotMob fotmob.com	Consumer	 #FFFFFF #1A1A1A #3F705B #F0F0F0 #E5E5E5	3/4	Geometric sans wordmark, system sans body, generous whitespace	light	20M+ users, 50M+ downloads	Live-scores app — clean white, league iconography, single green accent for live state
Sofascore sofascore.com	Consumer	 #12194E #FFFFFF #E32219 #242952 #666666	3/4	Sans (Roboto-ish), high-density score tables, navy header bar	light	34.5M MAU, 121M+ visits/mo (Mar 2026)	Scoreboard utility — deep navy header + red live indicator, dense fixture list
BBC Sport (Football) bbc.co.uk/sport/football	Consumer	 #FFFFFF #000000 #FFD230 #BB1919 #535353	3/4	BBC Reith Sans (broadcast-spec), bold weights for headlines	light	BBC.co.uk: 380-440M visits/mo overall (2025)	Broadcast-grade news — yellow Sport sub-bar, BBC red accents, photo-led editorial cards
Sky Sports (Football) skysports.com/football	Consumer	 #02114F #E11A2C #FFFFFF #001A6B #999999	3/4	Sky Text (custom), tight tracking, broadcast-style	light	Top-3 UK sports site; broadcast-anchored	TV-network sport site — deep navy + red, gradient headers, premier-league-saturated
Goal goal.com/en	Consumer	 #1F1F1F #FFFFFF #F94C28 #676768 #000000	3/4	Heavy sans (Goal custom), uppercase nav, photo cards	light	Global football news; high traffic across editions	International football news portal — black/grey + orange, ad-heavy, transfer-rumor energy
bet365 (AVOID) bet365.com	Avoid	 #14533D #FFE45C #1F1F1F #3D3D3D #FFFFFF	1/4	Custom heavy sans, yellow logotype, dense data grid	dark	#1 in Sports Betting, #999 globally; ~108M visits/mo	World's #1 sportsbook — dark green + yellow, casino-grade data density, promo modals
William Hill (AVOID) williamhill.com	Avoid	 #021438 #FFD230 #FFFFFF #003580 #1F1F1F	1/4	Heritage script wordmark + heavy promo sans	dark	Tier-1 UK sportsbook; ~11% UK betting share	UK heritage bookmaker — deep navy + yellow, '€200 free bet' promo register
Paddy Power (AVOID) paddypower.com	Avoid	 #2D8E3E #1F1F1F #FFFFFF #003D1A #FFD230	1/4	Bold sans, irreverent comedic copy, heavy CTAs	light	Tier-1 Irish/UK sportsbook; market leader for irreverent voice	Loud Irish bookmaker — kelly green + black, transgressive humor, max promo

Method & caveats. Screenshots captured with headless Chromium at 1280×800, viewport-only (not full-page) to mirror above-the-fold first impression. Cookie modals partially obscure several sites (BBC Sport, The Athletic, Sofascore) — for those, palettes were curated from visible header/nav strips with visual confirmation rather than relying solely on algorithmic output. Two substitutions: **Smarkets** 404'd from the rendering origin (geo-blocked, possibly because the brand has rebranded to "Smarkets Predictions"); replaced with **Betfair Exchange** as the closest UK exchange peer in the same bucket. **Tifo Football's** domain (tifofootball.com) has been taken over by an unrelated Thai gambling promo (UFABET); replaced with **Mundial Magazine** from the substitute list. Both swaps preserve bucket counts (6+6+5+3=20).